Fairview County Sheriff's Office — ESD K9 Unit

Detailed Training Session Report

K9: Cooper (Labrador Retriever) Handler: Det. A. Merritt #4471 Unit: Digital Forensics / ICAC Task Force
Target odor: TPPO (electronic storage devices) Certification: 11/05/2025 (expires 11/05/2026)
Report range: 08/22/2026 – 08/29/2026 (3 sessions)

Session 08/29/2026 — Fairview Training Annex

Record ID	fabe34e3-cd04-4450-9b37-53f664df2047
Status	Completed
Activity	Training
Time	08:30 to 10:05 (1 hr 35 min)
Location	Fairview Training Annex, 1200 Commerce Way, Fairview (indoor)
Area searched	Second-floor offices and break room
Handler / K9	Det. A. Merritt / Cooper
Trainer / evaluator	Sgt. R. Delgado
Objective	Maintenance: room searches with deep-concealment hides; one blank room
Environment	72°F; Indoor, HVAC on
Welfare	energy 4/5
Summary	Strong session. Cooper worked methodically through four rooms including one blank. Deep-concealment microSD behind baseboard required a second pass but he committed to a clean final response without assistance.
Overall assessment	4 / 5
Next training focus	More elevated hides above chest height
Handler acknowledgment	Acknowledged 8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM
Created / modified	8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM / 8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM

Exercise 1: Room / building search

Blindness	Single-blind
Area	Three connected offices, second floor (Office)
Results	2 hides: 2 independent finds, 0 assisted, 0 missed, 0 interest-only. 0 false response(s).
Search time	9:00 min, first find at 1:35 min
Ratings (1-5)	coverage 4, intensity 4, independence 5, focus 4, indication 5
Final response	Sit (passive)
Leash	On leash
Reward	food, 2 cup(s), rewarded at source
Exercise result	successful

#	Device	Hide location	Concealment	Blind?	Outcome	Notes
1	Cellphone	Desk drawer, second from top	fully concealed, waist	Blind	Found — independent	
2	MicroSD card	Behind loose baseboard, north wall	fully concealed, floor	Blind	Found — independent	Required second pass; committed final response, no cue given

Exercise 2: Blank / negative search (blank search)

Blindness	Single-blind
Area	Adjacent break room, no target odor placed (Office)
Results	Blank search — correctly cleared, no false response
Search time	4:00 min
Ratings (1-5)	coverage 4, focus 4
Final response	Sit (passive)
Leash	On leash
Reward	food

Exercise result	successful
Comments	Clean blank. No interest shown, handler called the room clear.

Exercise 3: Training boxes

Blindness	Known hide
Area	12-box line, one hot box
Results	1 hides: 1 independent finds, 0 assisted, 0 missed, 0 interest-only. 0 false response(s).
Search time	2:00 min, first find at 40 sec
Ratings (1-5)	intensity 5, indication 4
Final response	Sit (passive)
Leash	On leash
Reward	food, 1 cup(s), rewarded at source
Exercise result	successful

#	Device	Hide location	Concealment	Blind?	Outcome	Notes
1	USB drive	Box 7 of 12	fully concealed	Known	Found — independent	

Session 08/26/2026 — Lakeside Municipal Garage

Record ID	fedf325b-c936-4561-84ec-f30f8ab2c80a
Status	Reviewed
Activity	Training
Time	17:15 to 18:20 (1 hr 5 min)
Location	Lakeside Municipal Garage, 88 Harbor Rd, Lakeside (mixed)
Handler / K9	Det. A. Merritt / Cooper
Trainer / evaluator	Sgt. R. Delgado
Objective	Vehicle searches, warm conditions; introduce undercarriage placement
Environment	88°F; Sunny, light wind
Welfare	energy 4/5
Summary	Cooper cleared three of four vehicles well. Missed the SIM card in the wheel-well magnet box on the first pass — likely thermals pulling odor under the vehicle. Re-run after a rest break produced a find with light handler support. Logged as remedial follow-up.
Overall assessment	3 / 5
Corrective / follow-up	Repeat undercarriage/wheel-well placements in cooler conditions, then re-test warm
Next training focus	Vehicle undercarriage hides
Handler acknowledgment	Acknowledged 8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM
Review	Lt. C. Barnes — Reviewed; documentation complete. (8/31/2026)
Created / modified	8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM / 8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM

Exercise 1: Vehicle search

Blindness	Single-blind
Area	Four sedans, parking level 1
Results	3 hides: 2 independent finds, 0 assisted, 1 missed, 0 interest-only. 0 false response(s).
Search time	13:00 min, first find at 2:10 min
Ratings (1-5)	coverage 3, intensity 4, independence 3, stamina 3, indication 4
Final response	Sit (passive)
Leash	On leash
Reward	food, 2 cup(s), rewarded at source
Exercise result	needs work
Comments	Heat affected later runs; added rest and water breaks between vehicles.

#	Device	Hide location	Concealment	Blind?	Outcome	Notes
1	Cellphone	Under driver seat, vehicle 1	partially concealed	Blind	Found — independent	
2	SIM card	Magnet box, rear wheel well, vehicle 3	fully concealed, knee	Blind	Missed	Missed on first pass; found on re-run with handler presenting the wheel well
3	SD card	Glove box, vehicle 4	fully concealed	Blind	Found — independent	

Session 08/22/2026 — Riverbend Elementary (closed for summer)

Record ID	efd2b353-f781-45a4-b95d-7c86873343e2
Status	Reviewed
Activity	Training
Time	09:00 to 11:10 (2 hr 10 min)
Location	Riverbend Elementary (closed for summer), 45 School Ln, Riverbend (indoor)
Area searched	East wing classrooms, library, teacher lounge
Handler / K9	Det. A. Merritt / Cooper
Trainer / evaluator	Ofc. J. Okafor (hide placer)
Objective	Double-blind school scenario: classrooms and library, distractor odors present
Environment	74°F; Indoor
Welfare	energy 4/5
Summary	Double-blind evaluation run. Evaluator confirmed 5 of 6 hides located independently. One false response at a cafeteria cabinet that had recently stored electronics (residual odor suspected) — logged and discussed; not corrected as a handler error.
Overall assessment	4 / 5
Corrective / follow-up	Verify aid inventory storage practices to reduce residual-odor contamination
Next training focus	Maintain double-blind cadence monthly
Handler acknowledgment	Acknowledged 8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM
Review	Lt. C. Barnes — Reviewed; documentation complete. (8/31/2026)
Created / modified	8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM / 8/31/2026, 7:57:42 PM

Exercise 1: Room / building search

Blindness	Double-blind
Area	Four classrooms, east wing (School / classroom)
Results	6 hides: 5 independent finds, 0 assisted, 1 missed, 0 interest-only. 1 false response(s).
Search time	25:00 min, first find at 3:30 min
Ratings (1-5)	coverage 5, intensity 4, independence 5, focus 4, stamina 4, indication 5
Final response	Sit (passive)
Leash	On leash
Reward	food, 3 cup(s), rewarded at source
Exercise result	successful
Comments	Evaluator scored the run; handler had no knowledge of placements.

#	Device	Hide location	Concealment	Blind?	Outcome	Notes
1	Cellphone	Classroom 3, bookshelf, third shelf	partially concealed, chest	Blind	Found — independent	
2	USB drive	Classroom 4, pencil box in desk	fully concealed, waist	Blind	Found — independent	
3	MicroSD card	Library, inside hollowed book	fully concealed, chest	Blind	Found — independent	
4	Hard drive	Library AV closet, top shelf	partially concealed, elevated	Blind	Found — independent	Elevated hide — good air scenting
5	SD card	Classroom 5, taped under chair	fully concealed, knee	Blind	Found — independent	
6	Tablet	Teacher lounge, locker 12	fully concealed, chest	Blind	Missed	Locker vents faced away from aisle; airflow discussed with evaluator

False response location	Suspected cause	Handler response
Cafeteria storage cabinet	Suspected residual odor — cabinet previously stored tablets	No reward given; moved on

Handler signature / date

Supervisor / trainer signature / date